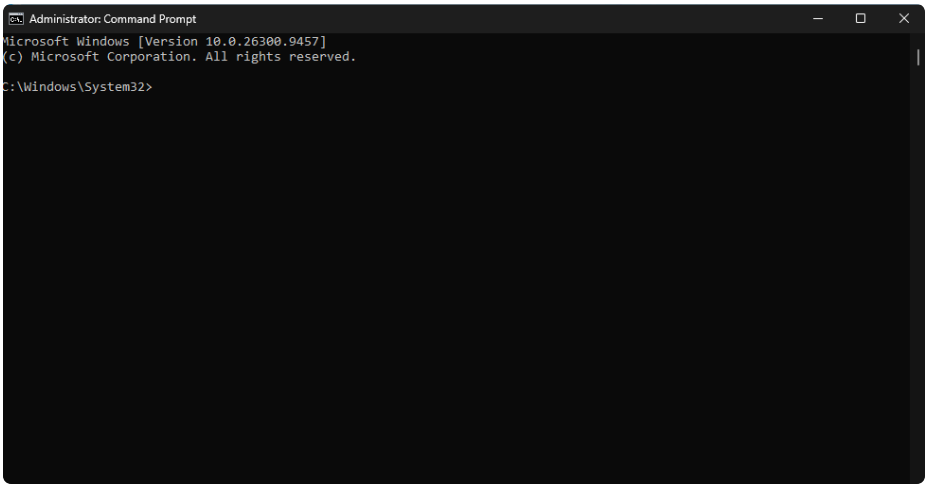
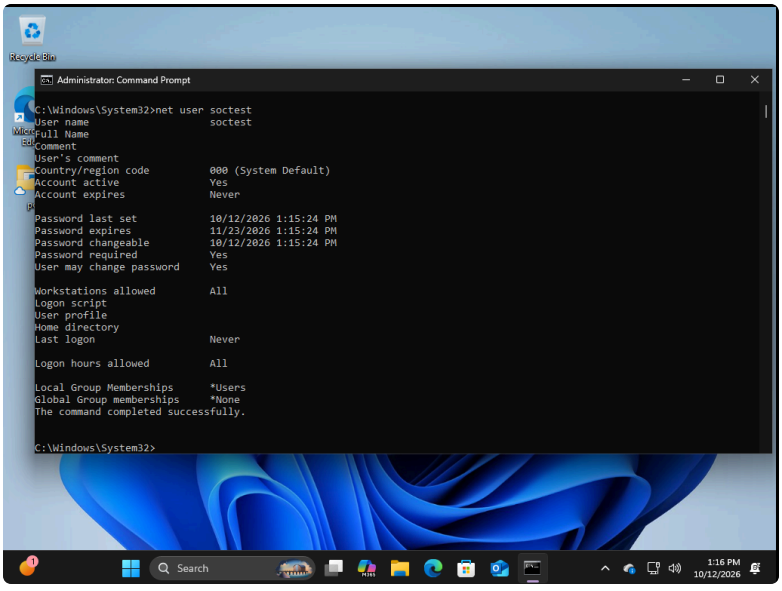
SOC Incident Analysis Report

1. Account Creation and Verification

- An elevated command prompt (running as administrator) was opened to execute administrative commands.



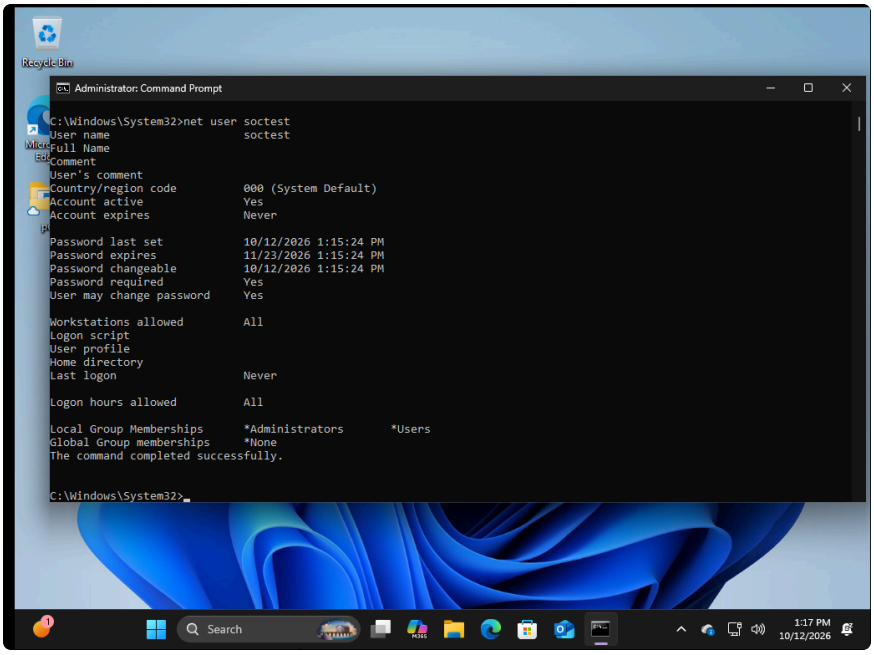
- A new user account named `soctest` was created by executing the command `net user /add soctest 12345`, where `12345` serves as the user password.
- The successful creation of the account was verified by running `net user soctest`.



2. Privilege Escalation

- The newly created user was added to the local Administrators group using the command `net localgroup Administrators soctest /add`, followed by `net user soctest` to

confirm the group assignment.



- Account SIDs were inspected and compared using `whoami /user` and `powershell -Command "Get-LocalUser soctest | Select-Object Name, SID"`.

```
User Name SID
========= ============================================
j0e\yosse S-1-5-21-2333110259-3012941579-1596334303-1001

C:\Windows\System32>
```

```
C:\Windows\System32>powershell -Command "Get-LocalUser soctest | Select-Object Name,SID"

Name    SID
----    ---
soctest S-1-5-21-2333110259-3012941579-1596334303-1002


C:\Windows\System32>
```

3. Folder Access Testing and Access Control Lists (ACLs)

- A target directory was created using `mkdir C:\SensitiveData`, and permissions were reviewed via `icacls C:\SensitiveData`.

```
C:\Windows\System32>mkdir C:\sensitivedata

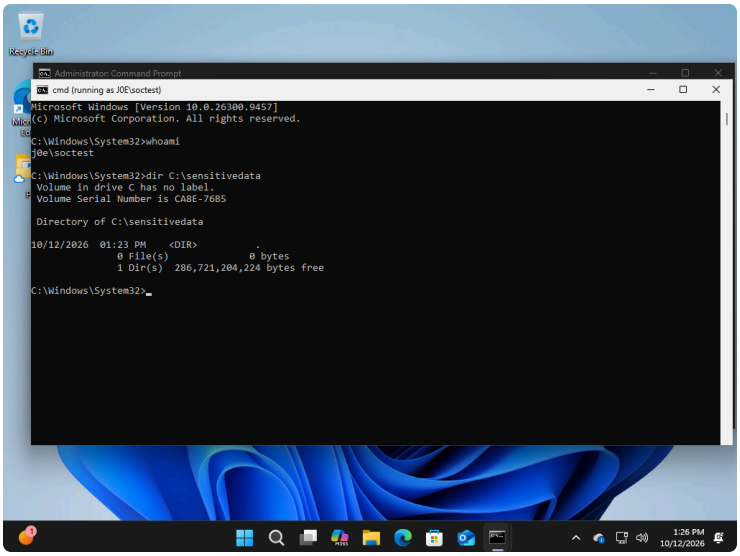
C:\Windows\System32>icacls C:\sensitivedata
C:\sensitivedata BUILTIN\Administrators:(I)(OI)(CI)(F)
                 NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM:(I)(OI)(CI)(F)
                 BUILTIN\Users:(I)(OI)(CI)(RX)
                 NT AUTHORITY\Authenticated Users:(I)(M)
                 NT AUTHORITY\Authenticated Users:(I)(OI)(CI)(IO)(M)

Successfully processed 1 files; Failed processing 0 files

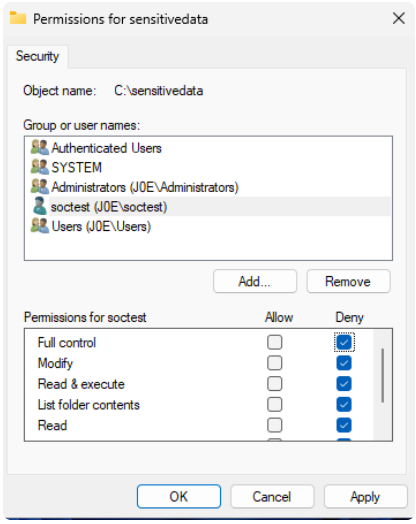
C:\Windows\System32>
```

- Pre-denial access was tested by spawning a command session under the test user profile via `runas /user:soctest cmd`, entering the password `12345`, and running `dir`

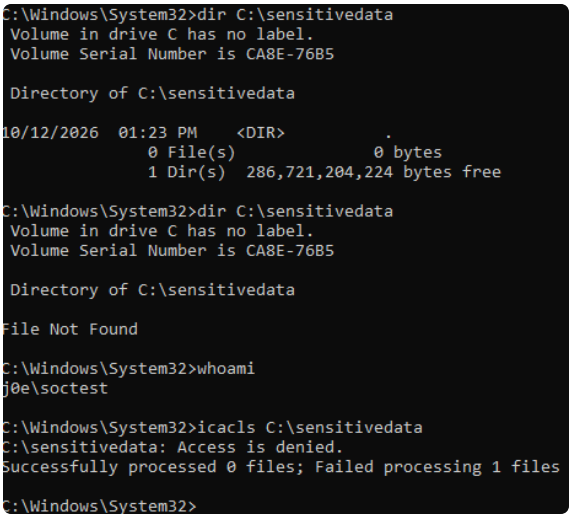
`C:\SensitiveData`.



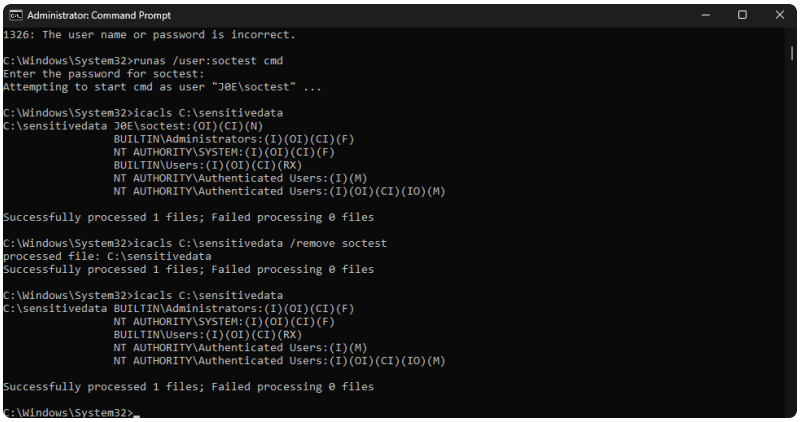
- Access was explicitly restricted by navigating through File Explorer properties, opening the Security tab, editing permissions, adding `soctest`, and checking the `Deny` box for Full Control.



- Post-restriction permissions were validated via `icacls C:\SensitiveData`, and tested in the user window using `dir C:\SensitiveData` and `icacls C:\SensitiveData`.



- The deny rule was removed using `icacls C:\SensitiveData /remove soctest` and verified with `icacls C:\SensitiveData`.



- User access was re-tested and confirmed restored via `dir C:\SensitiveData`.

```
C:\Windows\System32>dir C:\sensitivedata
 Volume in drive C has no label.
 Volume Serial Number is CA8E-76B5

 Directory of C:\sensitivedata

10/12/2026  01:23 PM    <DIR>          .
               0 File(s)              0 bytes
               1 Dir(s)  286,079,766,528 bytes free

C:\Windows\System32>icacls C:\sensitivedata
C:\sensitivedata BUILTIN\Administrators:(I)(OI)(CI)(F)
                 NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM:(I)(OI)(CI)(F)
                 BUILTIN\Users:(I)(OI)(CI)(RX)
                 NT AUTHORITY\Authenticated Users:(I)(M)
                 NT AUTHORITY\Authenticated Users:(I)(OI)(CI)(IO)(M)

Successfully processed 1 files; Failed processing 0 files

C:\Windows\System32>
```

4. Cleanup and Log Review

- The test account was deleted from the system using the command `net user/del soctest`, and verified via `net user`.

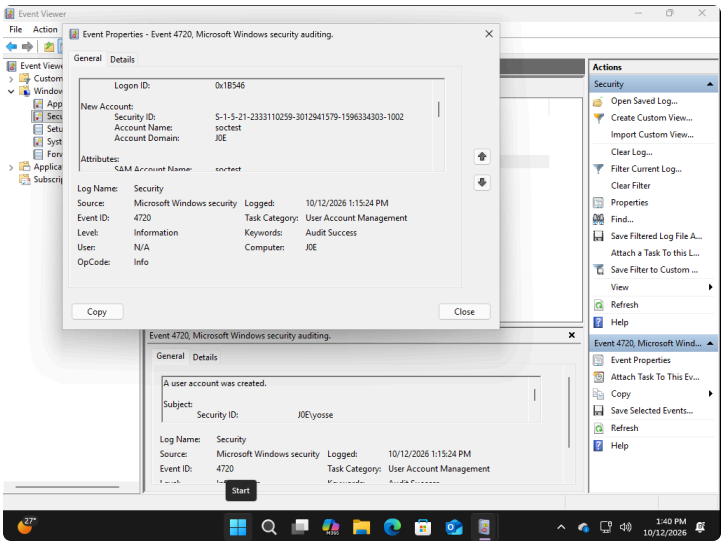
```
C:\Windows\System32>net user

User accounts for \\J0E

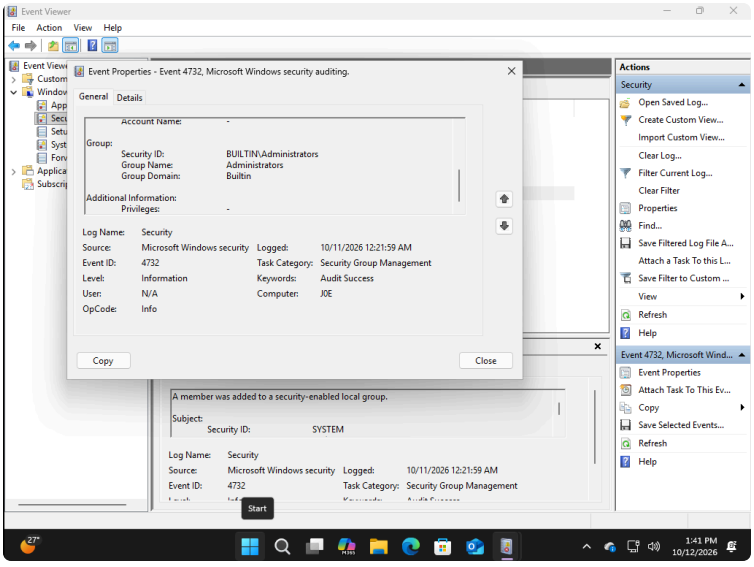
-------------------------------------------------------------------------------
Administrator            DefaultAccount           Guest
WDAGUtilityAccount       yosse
The command completed successfully.


C:\Windows\System32>
```

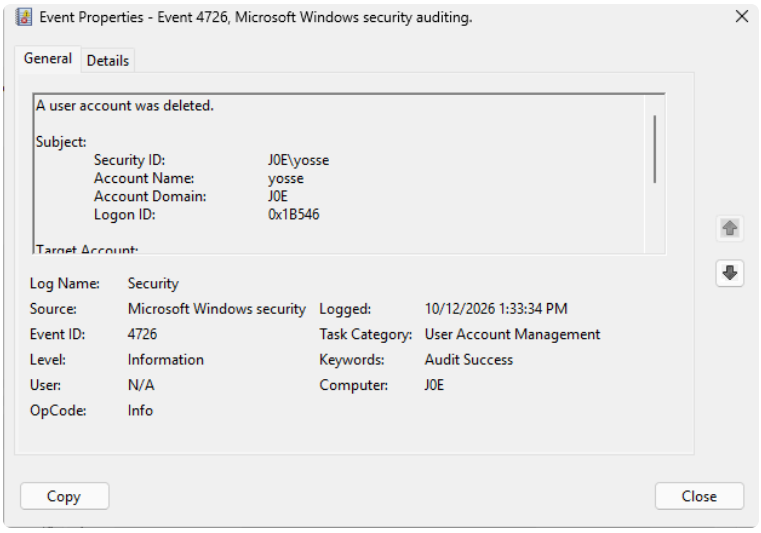
- Windows Event Viewer Security logs were filtered for Event IDs **4720**, **4732**, and **4726** to trace user lifecycle events.
  4720 (user created)



4732 (added to Administrators)



4726 (user deleted)



5. SOC Threat Analysis & Incident Evaluation

Why should a SOC Analyst consider this activity suspicious?

A SOC Analyst should consider this activity highly suspicious as it strongly indicates privilege escalation and persistence techniques commonly used by attackers. The sequence of Event ID 4720 (user creation) immediately followed by Event ID 4732 (adding the user to the local Administrators group) shows an unauthorized attempt to gain administrative privileges on the host. Furthermore, attackers often create rogue accounts to maintain persistent local or remote access to the system, and subsequent account deletion (Event ID 4726) may represent an effort to cover their tracks after completing malicious actions.